JOEL LEIVA

Elizabeth, NJ joseph2005castillo@gmail.com • 908-414-6885 • linkedin.com/in/joel-leiva0410

EDUCATION

Kean University — *Union, NJ* **Expected May 2027**
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science: Cybersecurity

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security & SIEM: Stellar Cyber SIEM, CrowdStrike Falcon, Okta (IAM/SSO/MFA), 24/7 Network Monitoring, Threat Triage

Networking & Firewalls: OPNsense, PRTG Network Monitor, Zone Segmentation (LAN/DMZ/WAN), NAT, VPN, Nginx, DNS

Systems & Cloud: Google Cloud Platform (GCP Console), Google Admin Portal (IAM), Active Directory (AD), Proxmox VE, RHEL

Operations & Tools: Freshservice (ITSM/Ticketing), SQL, Automation Scripting, OSINT

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA: Security+ | **Fortinet:** FCF (Fundamentals), FCA (Associate) | **Zscaler:** Zero Trust Certified Associate

WORK EXPERIENCE

Kean University, Information Technology — *Junior Security Operations (SecOps) Analyst* **June 2026 – Present**

- Execute 24/7 enterprise threat monitoring utilizing **Stellar Cyber SIEM** and **CrowdStrike Falcon**, triaging endpoint and network security alerts to minimize false positives and assess incident scope.
- Administer identity lifecycle management, access controls, and abnormal sign-in investigations across campus domains using **Okta**.
- Manage incident triage, escalation, and resolution tracking within **Freshservice**, collaborating with Network and Cloud Engineering teams on remediation.
- Support enterprise threat monitoring and security operations safeguarding campus digital infrastructure servicing 25,000+ students, faculty and staff.

House of Hearts Network, Department of Operations — *Strategic Operations & IT Manager* **August 2026 – Present**

- Manage digital identity lifecycle, authorization policies, and role-based access controls (IAM) via the **Google Admin Portal** to secure staff and service communications.
- Administer foundational organization resources within **Google Cloud Platform (GCP)** utilizing the Google Cloud Console for infrastructure reliability and identity auditing.
- Partner directly with executive leadership to modernize technology infrastructure, improving operational resilience and technology-supported community services.

Kean University, Center for Cybersecurity — *Threat Intelligence Analyst Intern* **Sept 2025 – May 2026**

- Conducted open-source threat intelligence (OSINT) research on ransomware, DDoS attacks, and breach vectors, producing actionable reports for 60+ non-profit organizations.
- Engineered and deployed a physical cybersecurity laboratory featuring managed switching, network storage, power distribution, and surveillance systems.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

VCCC / NCyTE Cybersecurity Career Challenge — *Virtual Network & Security Infrastructure* **Feb 2026 – May 2026**

- Engineered and secured a multi-tier, 10-endpoint enterprise network inside Proxmox VE over VPN, segmenting LAN, WAN, and DMZ zones using **OPNsense** firewalls with custom rules and NAT.
- Configured **Active Directory (AD)** and DNS for centralized identity alongside an **Nginx** reverse proxy and a back-end **SQL** database server.
- Implemented **PRTG Network Monitor** to maintain 24/7 visibility into endpoint availability, interface traffic, and latency across critical server nodes.
- Hardened a secure RHEL enterprise mail server running Postfix and Dovecot with TLS encryption and SASL authentication.